

Another World

Ice Breaker · Saturday, Oct 10 · about 5 minutes

1	0:00	Hello	center
2	0:50	My first world	your right
3	1:30	My second world	your left
4	2:45	The strange part	center
5	3:25	A new feeling	center
6	4:05	Why I am here	center

● 4:00 ● 5:00 ● 6:00 Yellow before part 6? Jump to the closing.

Grey question = what people wonder. Don't say it.

(Blue) = what to do.

Bold = say it slowly.

Orange bar = learn by heart.

1 · Hello

0:00 · Center

BY HEART

Привет. (pause) Salom. (pause)
안녕하세요. (pause) Hello.

Toastmaster of the day, fellow
Toastmasters, and dear guests.

What was that?

You just heard “hello” in four
languages: Russian, Uzbek,
Korean, and English.

Who are you?

My name is Azizjon. (pause) Azizjon
Kasimov.

Where from? What job?

I am from Uzbekistan, and I am an
AI engineer here in Daejeon.

What is your story?

Here is something strange.

What is strange?

Russian is my first language.

So you know it well?

I grew up with it.

And now?

But now, speaking Russian is hard for me.

How did that happen?

Let me tell you about my two worlds.

2 · My first world

0:50 · Step to your right (the past)

Where did it start?

I grew up in Tashkent, the capital of Uzbekistan, in a Russian-speaking family.

What did you speak at home?

At home, everything was in Russian.

Everything?

My family, my childhood, my first memories. All in Russian.

Do you speak Uzbek?

And Uzbek, the language of my country?

Yes, I said “Salom” at the start. But I can barely speak Uzbek.

(pause, small shrug)

So?

So my first world was in Russian.

How did it feel?

For me, it was just normal. I never thought about it.

Why didn't you notice?

When you live inside a language, you don't see it.

Like what?

A fish does not see the water.

3 · My second world

1:30 · *Walk to your left (the present)*

What happened next?

Then I came to Korea to study at Woosong University, here in Daejeon.

And?

And a new world started.

What did you learn?

I started learning Korean for daily life.

Is your Korean good now?

아직 공부 중이에요. *(pause, smile)* I am still learning.

What do you speak most?

But my main language here became English.

What was it for?

At first, it was just a tool for work.

What work?

I became an AI engineer.

What do you build?

I build models that forecast solar power, find hidden problems in data, and predict prices.

Any other language?

At work, I speak one more language.

Which one?

A programming language: Python.

(pause)

What is it like?

Python is the perfect listener.

Why perfect?

It never interrupts me. It never gets bored.

Any problem?

But when I make one small mistake, it tells me right away.

(robot voice) “Error.” *(pause)*

Only at work?

Slowly, English moved from my work into my whole life.

How much?

Today I speak English almost all day.

With whom?

With friends, with new people, and at home with my girlfriend.

So what is English now?

English is not my work language anymore. It is my life language.

4 • The strange part

2:45 • Come back to the center (now)

And Russian?

And here is the strange part.

(point back to the past side)

How do those years feel?

When I look back at the years
when I spoke mostly Russian,
they feel like another world.

And speaking Russian today?

And now, when I speak Russian, I
have to stop and search for
words.

So?

**My first language became my
second language.** *(pause)*

Did you learn something?

This taught me something.

What?

A language is not just words. It is a whole world.

So?

**When your language changes,
your world changes too.**

5 · A new feeling

3:25 · Center

Anything else?

But recently, I noticed one more change.

Another language?

This one is not a new language. It is a new feeling.

What feeling?

Talking to people became easier.

Only easier?

More than that, it became fun.

Why fun?

I can share my ideas, and people understand me.

What did you do?

This year, I tried new things.

Like what?

I started a small tech meetup here, called Daejeon Global Tech Coffee.

What else?

And last month, I started teaching English as a volunteer.

Had you taught before?

It was my first time ever teaching English.

How did it go?

Step by step, it got easier.

6 · Why I am here

4:05 · Center

What do you want now?

I want more of that feeling.

So?

That is why I am here.

How did you find us?

I came to this club three times as a guest.

And then?

Then my girlfriend and I joined the club together.

What is your goal?

My goal is simple: take every role I can, and speak as much as I can.

What do you like here?

And I like that here, people tell you what you did wrong.

Like who?

Just like Python. *(pause)* But much more kindly.

BY HEART

Every language gave me a new world.

Now I want to get better at sharing my world with other people.

Today, I shared a little of it with you.

I started with “hello” in four languages.

Let me finish with “thank you” in four languages.

Спасибо. Rahmat. 감사합니다.
Thank you.